



Main Idea & Author's Purpose

CPALMS standards

- ELA.2.R.2.3, ELA.3.R.2.3: Explain an author's purpose and how it develops in an informational text.
- ELA.2.R.2.2, ELA.3.R.2.2: Identify the central idea and explain how relevant details support that idea in a text.
- ELA.2.R.2.4, ELA.3.R.2.4: Explain an author's opinion or claim and how evidence supports it.

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**1. terms &
definitions**



**2. identifying
central idea &
supporting
details**



**3. identifying
author's
purpose/opinion**

Ice Breaker

What was the craziest
thing you did today?



Terms



- Main idea: “Big Idea” of a story that the author wants the audience to know
 - importance: helps reader summarize the story without details and identify the author’s main purpose
- Author’s purpose: main reason WHY the author wrote the text and help the reader understand its purpose
 - 3 primary purposes (PIE): 1) persuade-opinions, 2) inform-facts, 3) entertain-enjoyment
- Author’s claim/purpose is hidden within text details

Main Idea: short story

Inky is an adorable dog. She is a Cavachon. A Cavachon is a mix of Cavalier King and a Bichon Frise, but she looks Dalmatian. She is both intelligent and loving. She loves attention and always repeats behaviors that earn her praises. She is a distinguished companion. Anyone looking for a dog should consider Cavachons because they are very quiet. They hardly ever bark and are relatively small. They are ideal for families with small children. Best of all, Cavachons are easy to train. My dog Inky has already learned some cool tricks. She is the joy of our home.



1) What was the paragraph mostly about?

2) Give one possible detail to support your answer

3) Why are Cavachons good pets?

4) What do you think was the author's purpose?



Author's Purpose: Short Story

In 1972, Americans fell in love with two giant pandas named Hsing-Hsing and Ling-Ling. The pandas came to the United States from China. The National Zoo in Washington, D.C., became the pandas' new home. On their first day there, 20,000 people visited the two pandas. The crowds kept coming year after year. Hsing-Hsing and Ling-Ling were just cubs when they got to the United States. As the years passed, many hoped the pair would have cubs of their own. Ling-Ling gave birth several times. But none of the babies lived more than a few days. Each time a cub died, people around the world felt sad. Both pandas lived to an old age. Ling-Ling was 23 when she died in 1992. Hsing-Hsing died in 1999 at the age of 28. But the pandas were not forgotten. At the National Zoo, the glass walls of their home were covered with letters from children. The letters expressed the children's love for the pandas and told how much they were missed.



- 1) The author wrote this passage mostly to —
 - a) tell about Hsing-Hsing and Ling-Ling
 - b) explain where giant pandas come from
 - c) describe a giant panda's cubs
 - d) convince people to visit the National Zoo.
- 2) According to the author, how did people feel about the pandas? Provide a quote to support your answer
- 3) If you visited the National Zoo in 2000, what would you have seen at the pandas' home?
- 4) What kind of text is this? (informational, persuasive, entertaining)

practice
continued...



Have you ever been to New York City? There are many exciting things to see. One sight is the famous Brooklyn Bridge. It was built more than 100 years ago. Another is the Empire State Building. It is one of the tallest buildings in the world. You can take an elevator ride to the top of the building. From there, you can see for miles. One of the best things to see in New York is the Statue of Liberty. It stands on Liberty Island in New York Harbor. The best way to see the statue is to go to Battery Park. Stand in Battery Park looking out at the water. The Statue of Liberty is across the harbor in front of you. To the right you will see Ellis Island. Behind you is an old fort that you can explore. You can take a ferry from Battery Park to Liberty Island, if you want to see the statue up close. The Statue of Liberty is 151 feet high. It was given to the United States by France in 1884. The statue is a woman in a long robe holding a torch, and she stands for freedom. Since 1886, millions of people have visited the Statue of Liberty. For many people who came here by ship from other countries, the Statue of Liberty was the first thing they saw. It is an important symbol of our nation.

Questions

- 1) What kind of text is this?
- 2) Why is the statue of liberty important?



- 3) What is the author trying to make the reader do? Provide a specific quote that supports your answer



5 min break!!!!

drawing game:

<https://skribbl.io/>





Why do you think he is posed like this?

What does his facial expression tell you?

Under what conditions would you recreate this pose?

practice continued...

- 8/13: Dear Diary, There's a new girl named Sasha in our class. Mrs. Ramirez put Sasha at our table, right next to me. Then Mrs. Ramirez said, "Becky, I know you'll be a big help to Sasha." I smiled at Sasha, and she smiled back. Maybe we'll become friends. It would be so great to have a new friend!



- 8/17: Dear Diary, I am really upset with Sasha. I'm not sure I want to be her friend. I've been trying hard to be nice, but today she got me in big trouble! When I walked into the classroom, I broke a rule—I bounced the ball indoors. The ball landed on the counter and knocked over a flower pot. The flowers didn't get hurt, but dirt spilled all over the counter. Since Mrs. Ramirez was still out in the hall, all I had to do was pick up the pot and clean up the dirt. But before I could, Sasha ran and got Mrs. Ramirez. What a tattletale! Now I have to stay inside for recess tomorrow. I am so mad at Sasha!

1) What happened first?

- a) The class went to the computer lab**
- b) Becky got upset with Sasha**
- c) Mrs. Ramirez put Sasha at Becky's table**
- d) Sasha made a silent "thanks" with her mouth.**

2) Why did Becky have to stay inside for recess?

3) How did becky feel about Sasha at the beginning and end of the passage? Provide a quote to support your answer.





End of Lesson Questions

What is a main idea and what does it do for a text?

What is the author's purpose?
How does it help the reader?



What did you learn from each of the short stories?

